

THE FILMING DAY GUIDE

Built for Dustin Krzywy, Eastcountry Electric

APEX ACQ | APEXACQ.CO

Read this first (2 minutes)

Dustin, you're about to film the stuff that makes your phone ring. Here's the good news: **there is no script to memorize**. All you're doing is answering questions about work you've been doing for 20-plus years. You already know every answer.

This covers two things:

1. **The short ads.** 5 to 7 clips, 30 to 60 seconds each. These run alongside your panel-check ads on Facebook and Instagram, and real-face ads from the owner are the strongest format there is.
2. **The sales video (VSL).** One longer video, 2 to 4 minutes. This sits on your landing page and does the convincing before anyone calls.

You can do this with your phone. Some of the best-performing videos on landing pages like yours are 3-minute webcam recordings. Done beats perfect, every time.

How the session runs (about 60 minutes)

John runs it as the prompter, on a video call or in person. His job: read you one prompt at a time, keep you on topic, and make you redo your opening line once. That's it.

Time	What's happening
First 10 min	Warm up. Talk about your best recent job and the worst electrical horror story a customer brought you. Camera off.
Next 25 min	Film the ads. One idea at a time, from the prompt list below.
Next 15 min	Film the sales video. Question and answer style.
Next 5 min	The review video (easiest one, see Part 3).
Last 5 min	B-roll. The shop, the truck, the sign wall, the work.

PART 1: THE SHORT ADS

The only rule: think about your first sentence, then just talk

Every ad has three beats:

Beat 1: Stop the right homeowner (or farmer) from scrolling. Your first sentence. It's the only part worth thinking about before the camera rolls. Take 5 seconds, get it in your head, then go. Say what you do and the result they want.

Weak: "Hi, we're an electrical company in Ponoka." Strong: "If your panel's so full you're scared to plug in a block heater, this is for you."

Beat 2: Keep talking for about 30 seconds. No script. Stay on the one topic. What confuses people, what you do differently, what happened on a real job last month.

Beat 3: Land the plane. "If that sounds like your place, hit the button below and we'll take a look." Done.

The retake rule

Always redo your first take. Not because it was bad. Because the second one is always better. Everyone's second take wins. Plan on it.

YOUR PROMPT LIST (filmed one at a time, in this order)

1. **The full panel.** Hot tubs, EV chargers, welders in the shop. Talk about what you find when you open a panel that's been "making do" for 30 years, and what a free panel check actually involves.
2. **The fuse box farmhouse.** The oldest panel you've seen still running. What the owner didn't know, what could have happened, what it took to fix.
3. **Power out, 2 in the morning.** Who do people actually call when half the house goes dark and it's not the utility? Walk through what happens when someone calls you after hours.
4. **The grain dryer that quit in season.** Harvest is sitting there and the dryer's dead. Talk to the farmer who's been there. What you check first, how fast you move.
5. **The quote that never showed up.** Talk to the homeowner who called three electricians and heard back from none. What you do differently when someone calls Eastcountry.
6. **The breaker that keeps tripping.** Everybody just resets it and hopes. Tell them what it's actually telling them, and when it's time to stop resetting and start checking.
7. **The thing homeowners always get wrong about electrical.** Your pick. The myth you correct most often.
8. **Hail Mary close-out:** in about 60 seconds, just explain what Eastcountry does, who you do it for, and why someone in Ponoka, Lacombe, Wetaskiwin, Stettler or Red Deer should call you and not the other guy.

Same idea can become two ads. "Stop resetting that breaker" and "catch it before it burns" are the same message pointed at different people. If John asks you to say the same thing a different way, that's why.

PART 2: THE SALES VIDEO (VSL)

It's an interview. John asks, you answer, the questions get cut out in the edit. Only the first answer needs any practice.

1. The opener (the only part to run twice before filming). Shape, in your words: *"If you've got a panel you don't trust, a breaker that keeps tripping, or a quote from another electrician that never showed up, you're who we built this for. I'm Dustin, owner of Eastcountry Electric in Ponoka, and here's how we make sure your place is safe and the job actually gets done."* Your reviews and job photos get flashed on screen while you say it.

2. How you work. - What have your customers usually tried before they call you, and why did it let them down? - What's the first thing you do on every job? (The panel check, the straight assessment, telling them what they actually need and not more.) - What do most electrical companies skip after the job that you don't? - Then wrap it: "So, two things. First we [step one]. Then we [step two]."

3. The questions you hear on every single quote. Most common first. How fast can you get out here, do you do farm work, is the panel check really free, what does a 200-amp upgrade roughly involve. For results, say what customers tell you afterwards in their own words.

4. Who you are (15 seconds, said for their benefit). You have real ammo here, use it plainly: *"Because we've been doing this for over 20 years across central Alberta, Master Electrician certified, fully insured and WCB covered, you're not the test run. You're getting the version of us that already made the mistakes on someone else's dime."*

5. The close. *"So if you want a panel you don't have to think about, and you're done with companies that don't call back, fill out the short form below or call us. We'll tell you straight if it's a job for us."*

Two things to leave OUT: your prices, and anything you can't back up on your worst week.

PART 3: THE REVIEW VIDEO (3 minutes, easiest win of the day)

You've got real Google reviews. This is where they earn their keep.

Open your Google reviews on a screen. Hit record with your face in the corner. Scroll through and talk about the customers you remember:

"Here's [name]. I remember that job, the panel out at their acreage was..."

Two or three minutes, done. No prep, no polish. Don't let how easy it is fool you. This little video earns its spot on your landing page, and it takes less time than your coffee break.

PART 4: B-ROLL SHOT LIST

Grab 10 to 20 seconds of each:

- You walking toward the shop or a jobsite (toward camera, phone steady)
 - The truck, branding visible
 - The sign wall and the shop at golden hour (the sunset shots already performed well in your ads, more of that)
 - Close-ups: hands in a panel, the meter, the labeled breakers after a tidy job
 - A grain dryer, bin site or barn job if one's on the go
 - Before and after of a panel swap
 - **The landmark shot:** you in front of something everyone around Ponoka knows. The highway your customers drive daily, the main drag, your own shop sign. Locals trust faces they see in places they recognize.
-

IF YOU'RE USING A VIDEOGRAPHER: TECH SPECS (hand them this page)

Formats: Shoot everything in 4K. Frame the ads and the review video **vertical (9:16)**, safe for Reels and Stories. Shoot the VSL **horizontal (16:9)**, framed center so a vertical crop works too. If shooting one format only, go vertical for ads, horizontal for the VSL.

Audio: Lav mic on Dustin. Clean audio is non-negotiable, it matters more than the picture. No music on raw files.

Light: Daylight, sun on the face, never behind. Outside beats inside. Golden hour if the schedule allows, but don't chase it at the cost of the session.

First frame: For at least a few ad takes, put trust in the background of the opening shot: the truck, the sign wall, the shop, or an active jobsite. If a customer testimonial gets filmed at any point, hold a cutaway or split screen of Dustin in the first 3 seconds so viewers connect the face to the business.

Direction style: You are the prompter. Feed one idea at a time from the prompt list. Let him talk past stumbles, do not stop takes for small flubs. Always run the opener twice. If an answer ran long, ask "say that again, shorter." Keep him standing and moving, a still body makes a flat voice.

Delivery: Raw, ungraded files. Separate audio track if recorded. WeTransfer or Drive link to John at Apex. The edit, captions, and cutdowns are handled on the Apex side.

IF SOMEONE ELSE IS EDITING: WHAT THE FINISHED VIDEOS SHOULD LOOK LIKE

Default is simple: send raw files to John and the edit gets done for you. But if your videographer or an editor is cutting these, hand them this page. John sends 1 or 2 reference clips with the prompt list so everyone can see the target before cutting.

The short ads (30 to 60 seconds, vertical 9:16): - Open on the strongest take of the first sentence. The hook also goes on screen as big text for the first 3 seconds. - Tighten with jump cuts and punch-ins. A 3 minute raw take should cut to 30 to 60 seconds. Cut the dead air, keep the energy. - **Captions burned in, always.** Most people watch with the sound off. Big, readable, high contrast, and kept out of the bottom fifth of the frame so app buttons don't cover them. - Keep it human. Leave the small stumbles and the ums in. If it gets polished to news anchor smooth, it stops working. Cut mistakes, not personality. - End card, 2 to 3 seconds: Eastcountry Electric logo, "Call 403-340-9213" and the button line ("Tap below to book your free panel check"). - No stock footage, no AI imagery, no cheesy transitions. Real footage only.

The sales video (VSL, horizontal 16:9, 2 to 4 minutes): - Cut the prompter's questions out so it plays as Dustin talking straight to the homeowner. - **Spend most of the editing effort on the first 30 seconds.** While Dustin runs the opener, flash proof on screen: his Google reviews (4 plus stars), real job photos, the truck and shop. The rest of the video can stay almost bare. - Layer B-roll over the talking wherever it matches what's being said. Talking head alone is fine for the back half. - Captions on, same rules as the ads. - Light background music is fine here, kept low. None on the ads. - Thumbnail: pick the most visually engaging working moment, not a frozen mid-word face.

The review video: - Captions burned in. That's the whole edit. Keep it raw, that's why it works.

Brand basics: match the look of the existing Eastcountry ads (the sunset shop and sign wall photos John has on file). Logo small in a corner or on the end card only, never plastered over the footage.

OWNER'S CHECKLIST FOR THE DAY

- Phone charged, lens wiped
- Wear what you wear to work. Eastcountry shirt if you have one. Don't dress up
- Location: the shop, the sign wall, or an active jobsite. Outside, sun on your face
- Quiet enough to talk without shouting
- Coffee. Nothing else

Mess up a line? Say it again. Nobody ever sees the bad takes.

Questions before the shoot? Text John.